



Welcome to CNECTS Industry Day

11 March 2026

Michael Tidwell
Rosalind Davis
Austin Frindt
CAO 11 March 2026

Highest Overall Classification:

UNCLASSIFIED

WE PUT THE "ACE" IN SPACE

Agenda

Timeline	Activity	Presenters
0915 – 0945	Welcome, Agenda, ROEs, and Introductions	SAIO
0945 – 1100	CNECTS Requirement	SAIO 21 CS
1100 – 1115	Short Break	
1115 – 1145	Risks and Challenges	21 CS SAIO Industry
1145 – 1215	CSO Process and Acquisition Strategy	SAIO
1215 – 1345	Break for Lunch	
1345 – 1430	BIM Impact Discussion	21 CS SAIO Industry
1430 – 1500	Milestones and Future Engagement	SAIO

Rules of Engagement

In-Person

- Meeting is being recorded and transcribed; AI assistance may be employed in the analysis of the transcription
- Cell phones on silent
- Discussion and questions are *highly* encouraged
- Nothing discussed today should be construed as government direction
- SAIO is currently entertaining 30-minute one-to-one meetings with industry upon request
- All dates and requirements discussed are subject to change

Rules of Engagement

Online

- Meeting is being recorded and transcribed; AI assistance may be employed in the analysis of the transcription
- Microphones will be muted
- Please turn off all webcams in order to conserve bandwidth
- Discussion and questions are *highly* encouraged – please place questions or comments in the chat to be addressed at the earliest available opportunity
- Nothing discussed today should be construed as government direction

Introductions

- 21st Communications Squadron – Customer | Requirement Owner
 - Dave Hluska – Director
 - Michael “Micky” Hovenkamp – Deputy Director
 - Andre Farr – Director of Plans & Sr Liaison Officer Schriever
 - Chad Denaughel – Director of Operations & Sr Liaison Officer Peterson
 - Rita Hahn – Director of Missions & Sr Liaison Officer Cheyenne Mountain
- SAIO – Program Management | Contracting | Quality Assurance
 - Michael Tidwell – Program Manager
 - Rosalind Davis – Contracting Officer
 - Austin Frindt – Acquisition Advisor
 - Clint Walker – Quality Assurance Program Manager



SEMPER VENATOR

MISSION DELTA 2

HQ: Peterson SFB, CO



SDA | SPACE DOMAIN AWARENESS

Provides Space Domain Awareness forces to protect our Nation's interests in, from, and to space

MISSION DELTA 3

HQ: Peterson SFB, CO



SEW | SPACE ELECTROMAGNETIC WARFARE

Operates electromagnetic attack, protection and support capabilities to protect and defend the space domain

MISSION DELTA 4

HQ: Buckley SFB, CO



MWT | MISSILE WARNING & TRACKING

Provides strategic and theater missile warning to the United States and our International Partners

MISSION DELTA 6

HQ: Schriever SFB, CO



CW | CYBERSPACE WARFARE

Generates, presents, sustains and improves Cyberspace Warfare forces for the Joint Force; Executes CW operations to enable Space Control for Service and Joint Operations

SPACE DELTA 7

HQ: Peterson SFB, CO



ISRT | INTELLIGENCE, SURVEILLANCE, RECONNAISSANCE & TARGETING

Conducts ISR ops and targeting in coordination with space domain operators, Intelligence Community partners and Joint warfighters worldwide to detect, characterize and target adversary space capabilities

MISSION DELTA 8

HQ: Schriever SFB, CO



SATCOM | SATELLITE COMMUNICATIONS

Delivers assured, effective, and resilient Satellite Communications for our Nation to connect and project space capabilities worldwide

MISSION DELTAS and SPACE DELTAS

Generate and present combat-ready space forces for employment

SPACE BASE DELTAS

Execute combat support and combat service support functions to project space power for the nation

MISSION DELTA 9

HQ: Schriever SFB, CO



OW | ORBITAL WARFARE

Responsible for organizing, training, equipping, generating and sustaining combat-ready forces to conduct Orbital Warfare operations

MISSION DELTA 31

HQ: Peterson SFB, CO



NAVWAR & SC | NAVIGATIONAL WARFARE & SATELLITE CONTROL

Provides, operates, and sustains Satellite Control and Navigation Warfare to protect our nation's interests.

SPACE BASE DELTA 1



MISSION SUPPORT | PETERSON SFB, CO

+ Pituffik SB, Greenland | Cheyenne Mountain SFS, CO | Maui SSC, HI | +19 mission locations worldwide

SPACE BASE DELTA 41



MISSION SUPPORT | SCHRIEVER SFB, CO

+ Ka'ena Point SFS, HI | New Boston SFS, MA

SPACE BASE DELTA 2



MISSION SUPPORT | BUCKLEY SFB, CO

+ Cape Cod SFS, MA | Cavalier SFS, ND | Clear SFS, AK | +10 mission locations worldwide

SPACE MISSION SQUADRONS:

CDS: Capability Development Sq
CYS: Cyberspace Sq
EWS: Electromagnetic Warfare Sq
ISRS: Intel Surveillance & Recon Sq
NWS: Navigation Warfare Sq
SCS: Satellite Comm Sq

SDS: Space Defense Sq
SOPS: Space Operations Sq
SPSS: Space Surveillance Sq
STS: Sustainment Sq
SWS: Space Warning Sq
TIS: Tactical Intel Sq

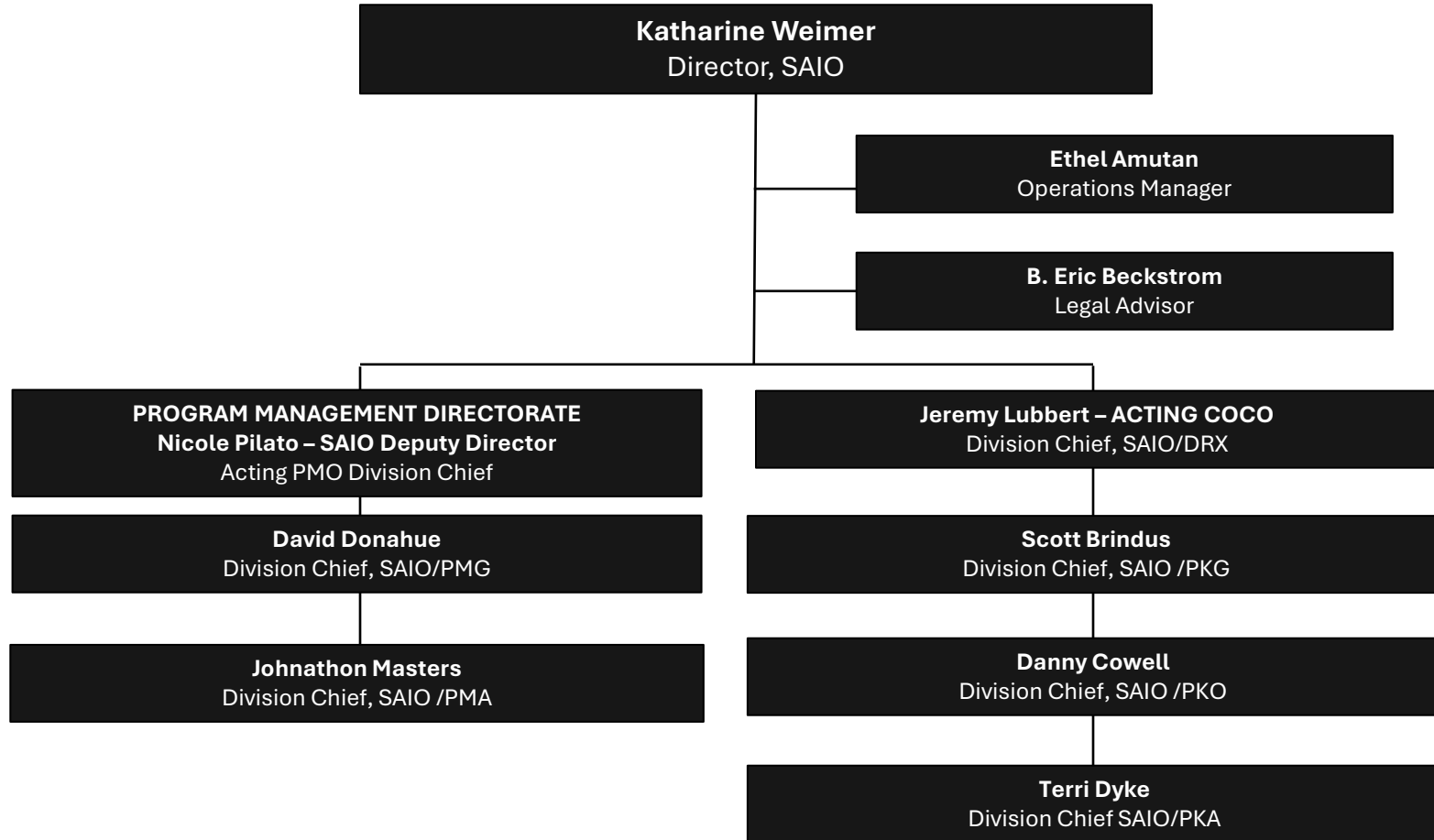
*Squadron emblem designs currently pending final approval

INSTALLATION & MISSION SUPPORT UNITS:

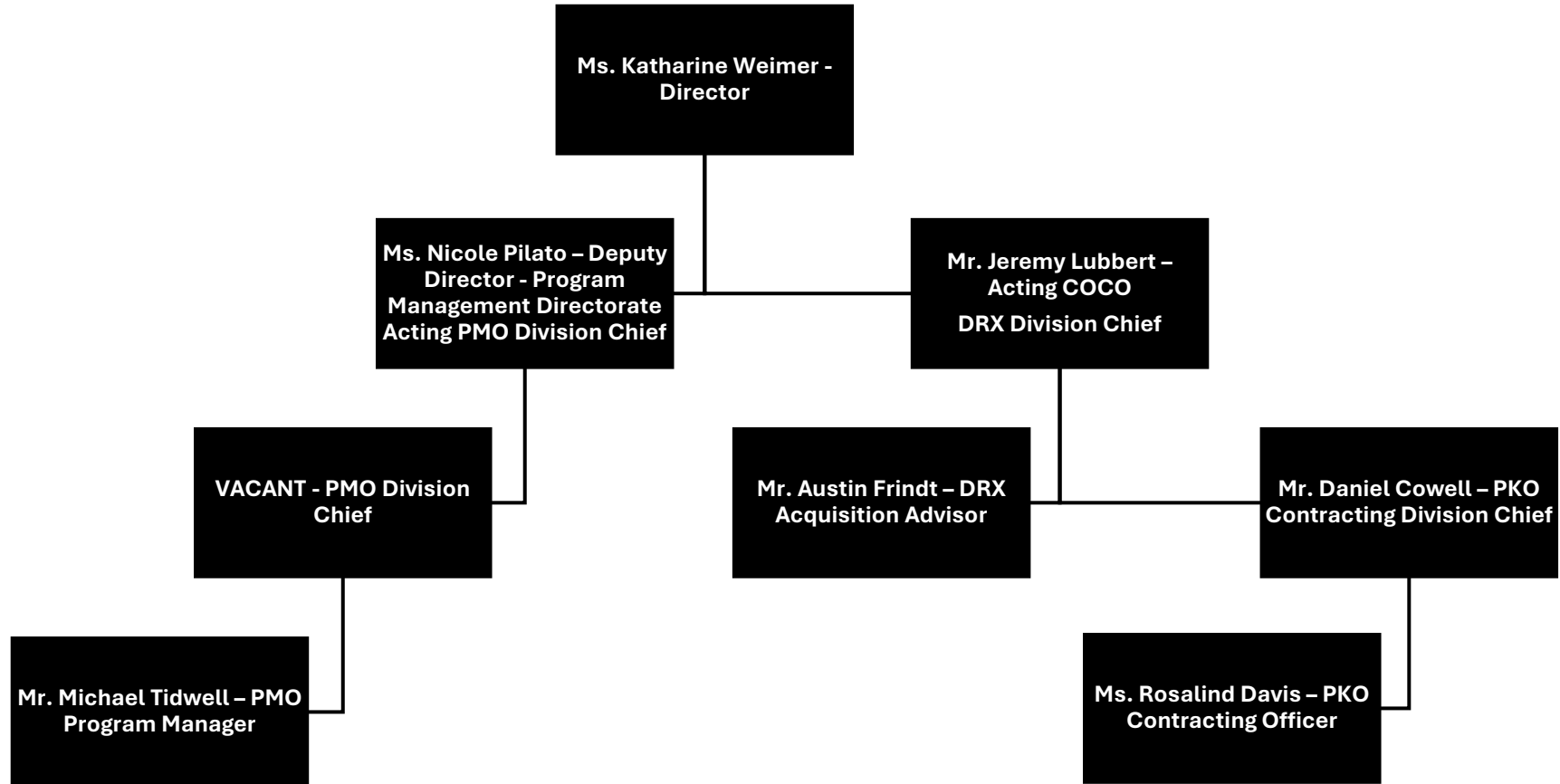
CES: Civil Engineering Sq
CONS: Contracting Sq
CPTS: Comptroller Sq
CS: Communications Sq
FSS: Force Support Sq
LRF: Logistics Readiness Flight
LRS: Logistics Readiness Sq
MDG: Medical Group
OL MSG: Operating Location Mission Support Group
SBG: Space Base Group
SFS: Security Forces Sq
**MDGs and SBGs have additional squadrons within their organizations



SAIO Org Chart



SAIO Org Chart – CNECTS





21st Communications Squadron

CNECTS Industry Day Brief



DAVID J. HLUSKA, NH-04, DAFC
Director, 21st Communication Squadron

Overall Classification: *Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI)*





Fast Facts



- ~50 work centers across 3 bases
 - 10+ 24x7 work centers
- Manpower
 - 8 Officer Billets
 - 29 Enlisted Billets
 - 174 Civilian Billets
- 4 Contracts (~400 Contractors)
 - NISC II--SSC (Mission Comms and BOS Comms at CMSFS and some Mission Comms at PSFB)
 - WICS II--SAIO (Mission Comms and some BOS Comms at SSFB)
 - Encore--21 CONS (BOS Comms at PSFB and Some BOS Comms at SSFB)
 - PEDS—50 CONS (Engineering for SSFB)
- Customer Support (Mission & BOS Communications)
 - 3 Space Force Installations
 - 111 Mission Partners
 - 2x CCMDs
 - NORAD & USNORTHCOM
 - USSPACECOM
 - 2x FIELDCOMs equivalents
 - CFC HQ
 - STARCOM HQ
 - 9 Deltas (Space, Space Base, Mission)
 - MDA, DIA, NRO
 - 57-125 GSUs (includes 20+ off-base facilities)
 - Combined: ~25K users, >30K devices, >40K phone lines
 - Support to 48 GOs/equivalent & visiting DVs



CUI

21st Communications Squadron

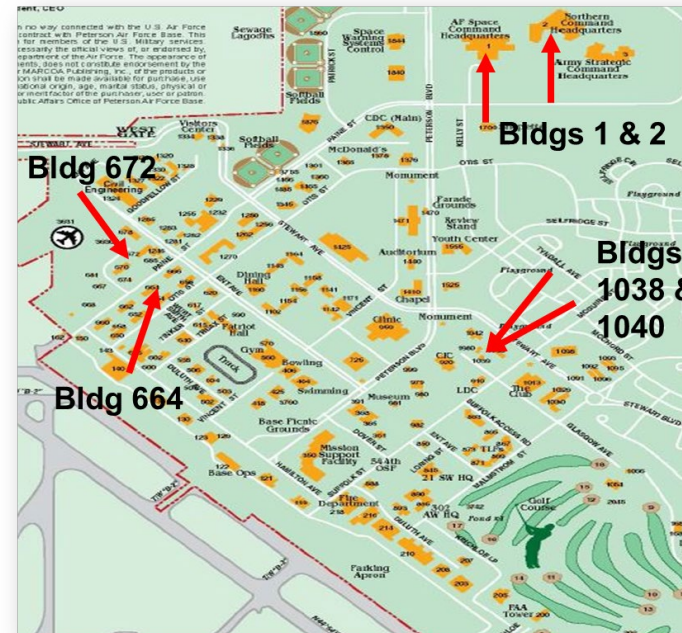


LOCATIONS

Cheyenne Mountain SFS



Peterson SFB



Schriever SFB



CUI



21st Communications Squadron



SBD 1/CC

Director, Mission Support

Director (21 CS/CL)

Deputy Director (DD)

Squadron Programs Director

- QA
- FOIA, Records Mgt
- Publications
- Privacy Act
- Security Mgt
- UPC

Director of Plans (DX)

Senior Liaison Officer – Schriever SFB

Director of Mission (DM)

Senior Liaison Officer – Cheyenne Mtn SFS

Director of Operations (DO)

Senior Liaison Officer – Peterson SFB

21st Communications Squadron



Director of Plans (DX)

Cyber Surety Flight (SCD)

Cybersecurity

Risk Management

Authority to Operate/Authority to Connect

"Wing" IA Programs

Negligent Discharge of Classified Information (NDCI)

COMSEC

KeyMat Issuance

High Assurance Internet Protocol Encryptor (HAIPE)

Compliance

Personnel Reliability Program (PRP)

COMSEC

ISSM

ISSO, RME,
COMPUSEC,
TEMPEST

Plans and Resources Flight (SCX)

Plans

Project Management

Service Catalog

Plans Development/Review

GSU Support

Configuration Management

Resource Management

Resource Advisors

Contracting Officer Representatives (COR)

Functional Area Agreement Coordinator (FAAC)

Engineering Services

Network and Cable Engineering

Plans

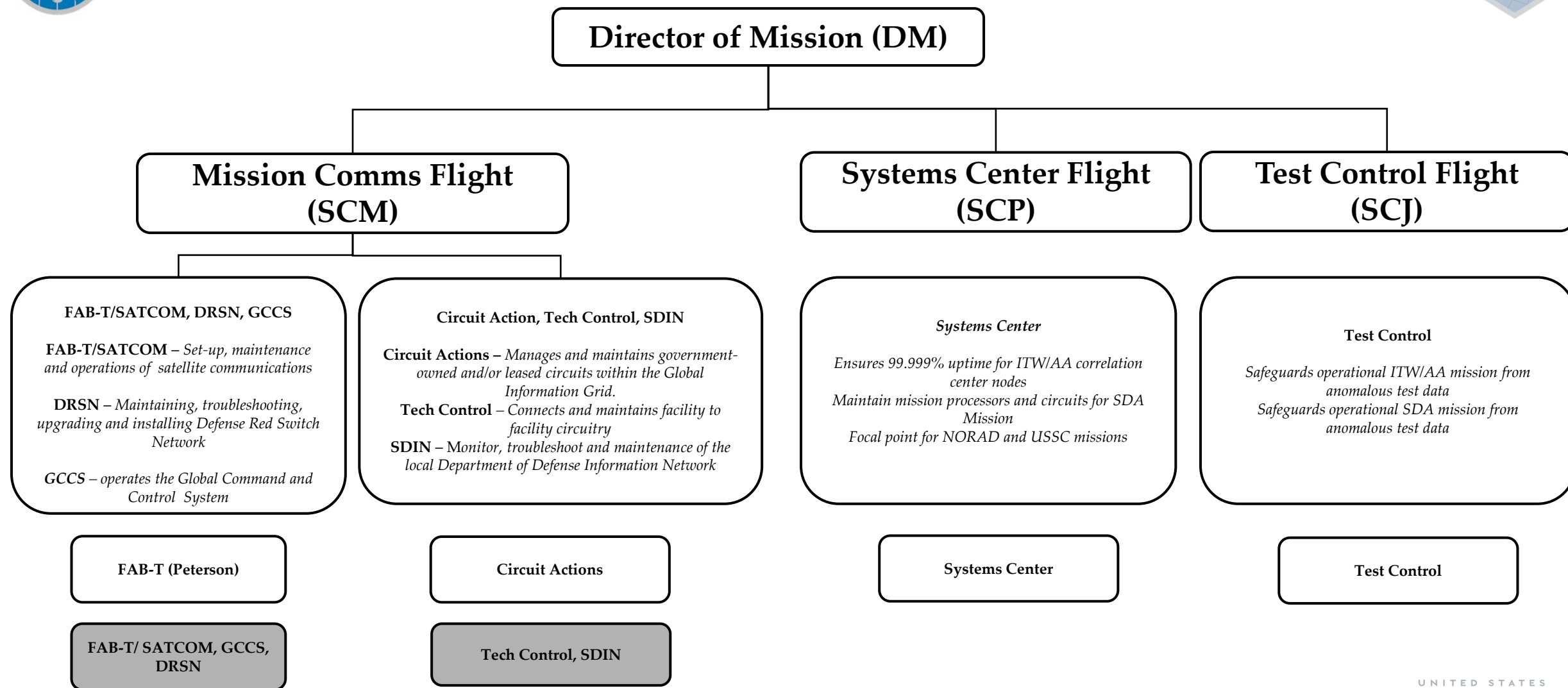
Resource Mgt

Engineering
Mission, GSU and Configuration
Mgmt

AFNET Engineering
Network & Cable



21st Communications Squadron





21st Communications Squadron



Director of Operations (DO)

Transmission Systems

Land Mobile Radio (LMR) –
*Programming and maintenance of
two-way wireless communication
system*

**Giant Voice (Announcement
Towers)** – Preventative maintenance,
trouble shooting, upgrades

Spectrum Management – regulation
and allocation of radio frequency
spectrum

LMR
Spectrum Management

Giant Voice

Cable Maintenance

Cable Mapping – Surveying and documenting
cable fiber from Main Distribution Center to
desktop

Inside Plant (ISP) – Fiber/Copper from Comm
Closet to desktop install/maintenance

Outside Plant (OSP) - Fiber between buildings
**Manhole Preventative Maintenance
Inspections (PMI)**

Cable Mapping

**Non-AFNET ISP/OSP, Cable PMI,
Antenna PMI**

AFNET ISP/OSP

VM/CFP/CST/BECO

Vulnerability Mgmt (VM) – *detects.
Assess and remediates network
vulnerabilities*

Communication Focal Point (CFP) -
*trouble ticket assignment/tracking,
SITREP, PMI mgmt., ASI
tracking/submission*

Client System Technician (CST) –
*Desktop devices install/troubleshooting
(voice, NIPR/SIPR, Monitor, etc), Comm
Closet to Desktop connectivity, Mission
Display, Mission Systems, Video
Maintenance*

**Base Equipment Custodial Officer
(BECO)** – *Hardware/Software asset
management*

VM

BECO, CST, CFP



21st Communications Squadron



Director of Operations (DO) Cont.

Systems Admin Section

File Services – manages data storage servers as well as manages storage and performs file screening management

Web Management – management/administration and optimization of servers that host websites and web applications

DB Services – Management and Maintenance of Database Servers

Virtualization – ensure VDI (Zero Clients) environments run efficiently. Deployment, management and optimizing virtual machines.

**File Services/
Web/DB/Virtualization**

Network Maintenance

Monitor network performance, conduct regular maintenance, troubleshoots issues, ensures optimal functionality and security

Network Technicians

**Network Monitoring &
AFNET NIPRNet
Wireless**



21st Communications Squadron



CMSFS N-NC SUPPORT

**N-NC
Network Technicians
and Engineering**

**N-NC
File Services/
Web/DB/Virtualization**

**N/NC
VM, CST, CFP**

ISSO, RMF

CNECTS Requirement and Legacy Contracts

Legacy PWSs and Consolidation D&F
available at [Sam.Gov](https://www.sam.gov) or by request.

21 CS Requirement History

- Early 2000s
 - Office of Management and Budget (OMB) Circular A-76
 - Gov vs CTR cost comparison
 - CTR determined “best value”
 - 48% RIF
- 2009
 - Resource Management Decision (RMD) 802
 - Government Contract Reform
 - Dep SecDef issued contract insourcing
 - 21 and 50 Communications Squadron insource
 - 20% RIF

21 CS Requirement History (contd)

- 2011

- Budget Control Act of 2011 – Gov wide sequestration
 - Reduce Gov manpower to 2010 levels
 - Insourced billets from RMD 802 cut
 - 21CS/50CS left with no CTR support and limited CIV staff
 - Limited MIL billets realigned to augment losses
 - 21CS and 21SW realigned leaving 25% overall staffing

- 2020

- SBD6 Established
 - MIL Billets converted to Cyber Defense
 - MIL Communications Squadron support outsourced to CTR

CNECTS Requirement

- Four separate contracts require significant manpower, funding, and resources to manage
- 21 CS Realignment
 - CIV leadership for all 3 sites
 - Network admin and technicians covered
 - Web/Database/Virtual Desktop covered
 - Unclassified Voice services covered
- 21 CS contacted SAIO to determine feasibility of consolidation
- SAIO determined that requirements across bases were similar in nature, with few outliers
- SAIO issued a Consolidation Determination and Findings, which was approved by AFICC/KS in late 2025
- Base Operating Support – Information Technology (BOS-IT)
 - 31 July 2027
- North American Aerospace Defense Command Cheyenne Mountain Complex – Integrated Tactical Warning/Attack Assessment (NCCMC-ITW/AA) and Space Support Contract (NISSC)
 - 30 November 2027
- Wing Information and Communications Support (WICS II)
 - 30 Mar 2028
- Plans and Programs Engineering Design Support (PEDS)
 - 28 June 2028

BOS-IT Historical Requirement

- Supports 21 CS at Schriever and Peterson
 - FAB-T
 - Giant Voice
 - BECO
 - Client Systems Technicians (CST)
 - Comm Focal Point
 - NetOps/File Service/Web/DB/Virtualization
 - Cable Shop
 - Network Technicians
 - Local Registration Authority (LRA)
 - Enterprise Information Management
 - Unclassified VoIP

NISSC Historical Requirement

- Supports 21 CS at CMSFS

- FAB-T
- Cybersecurity
- Giant Voice
- Cable Shop
- Vulnerability Management
- BECO
- Client Systems Technicians
- Comm Focal Point
- NetOps/File Service/Web/DB/Virtualization

- Supports 21 CS at CMSFS

- Network Engineering
- Network Administration
- Local Registration Authority (LRA)
- Special Security Reps (SSR)
- Network Operations Center (NOC)
- Technical Control Facility (TCF)
- Video Work Center
- Global Command and Control System (GCCS)

NISSC Historical Requirement (contd)

- Supports 21 CS at CMSFS
 - Defense Red Switch Network (DRSN)
 - MILSTAR
 - PNVC
 - Unclass VoIP
 - Unclass TDM
 - LMR
 - Circuit Actions

WICS Historical Requirement

- Supports 21 CS at Schriever SFB
 - Global Broadcast Operations Center (GBSOC)
 - Wideband Global Satellite
 - FAB-T
 - GCCS
 - SDIN
 - Database
 - Power/System Safety/Operations Systems
 - ISSO
 - Technical Control Facility (TCF)
 - Circuit Actions

PEDS Historical Requirement

- Supports 21 CS at Cheyenne Mountain SFS
 - Network Engineering
 - Cable Engineering



Mission Systems Operations



Space Digital Integrated Network (SDIN)

- Location: Schriever, GSUs
- Classification: Secret
- Ops Tempo: 24/7/365
- Cybersecurity Posture: RMF
- Continuity: NO FAIL

Global Command and Control System (GCCS)

- Location: Schriever, CMSFS
- Classification: Secret
- Ops Tempo: M-F
- Cybersecurity Posture: Ops
- Continuity: 24 Hr Turn



Mission Systems Operations



Steel Pipe

- Location: Schriever
- Classification: Secret
- Ops Tempo: 24/7/365
- Interdependencies: SDIN
- Continuity: NO FAIL

Modernization of Enterprise Terminals (MET) Earth Terminal

- Location: Schriever, Radomes AG1 and AG2
- Classification: Secret
- Ops Tempo: 24/7/365
- Interdependencies: DCSS
- Cybersecurity Posture: OPS/IAT Level 2
- Continuity: NO FAIL



Mission Systems Operations



Family of Advanced BLOS Terminal (FAB-T) Command Post

- Location: Schriever, FAB-T Tower, Antenna, and Radome
- Classification: Secret
- Ops Tempo: 24/7/365
- Cybersecurity Posture: OPS, IAT Level 2
- Continuity: NO FAIL

Short Break

Please return by 10:40

Risks and Challenges

Industry risk will be covered during the CSO discussion.

Risk Considerations | Knowledge Capture

- Schedule
 - 60 to 90-Day Transition Period
 - Applies to each legacy requirement
 - Base/RA Access
 - Clearance Verification/Finalization
- Cost
 - Incumbent/Knowledge Capture
 - Legacy Systems/Requirements
 - Modernization/Integration
 - Historical Architectures
 - Key Personnel Requirements
 - Still in Development
 - Open to Input
- Critical Knowledge Base
 - AFIs
 - DAFMANs
 - Confined Space

Risk Consideration (contd)

- Cost Risks

- Consolidation
- External Program Funding
- Travel Requirements
- Software License Management
- Technology Refresh/Obsolescence

- Schedule Risks

- Contract Award Timeline
- Phase-in Schedule
- Security Clearance Processing
- Cybersecurity Certifications
 - IAT II
 - IAM II
 - CMMC 2
- Confined Space Access

Risk Consideration (contd)

- Performance Risks

- Consolidation Inefficiency
- CFP Consolidation
- Cyber RMF Compliance
- COMSEC Management
- Mission System Maintenance
- Cable Plant Documentation

- Performance Risks

- Entry Level Position Retention
- Confined Space Project Management and Coordination
- IT Asset Management/Handoff
- DRSN Expertise
- Special Security Representatives

Quality Assurance and Surveillance

- COR Engagement
 - Continuity
 - Embedded SME Support
 - Regular Feedback
 - Semi-monthly Tagups
 - SAIO Led
 - COR Attended
 - CTR SME Support Recommended
 - Monthly Surveillance Reporting
 - CPAR Documentation Support
 - SAIO Managed
- Quarterly Program Management Reviews (PMRs)
 - SAIO Led
 - Cost
 - Schedule
 - Performance
 - Risk
 - Deliverable
 - Staffing

Commercial Solutions Offerings (CSO) Overview and Proposed Acquisition Strategy

Please provide comments and discussion on CSO process, white paper format, and evaluation factors during this time.



CNECTS

(Communications, Network, Engineering, Cybersecurity, and
Information Technology Services)

Commercial Solutions Opening (CSO) Overview

11 March 2026

Austin Frindt
SAIO/DRX

UNCLASSIFIED

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Overview

- **Why Now?**
- **How do CSOs Work?**
- **Sample Process Flow**
- **Backup (BAA Process)**

Why Now?

- **SECDEF Memo: Directing Modern Software Acquisition to Maximize Lethality, 6 March 2025**
 - “Effective immediately... ***I am directing the use of Commercial Solutions Openings*** and Other Transactions as the default solicitation and award approaches for acquiring capabilities under the Software Acquisition Pathway.”
- **Executive Order: Modernizing Defense Acquisitions And Spurring Innovation In The Defense Industrial Base, 9 April 2025**
 - “Incorporate... a first preference for ***commercial solutions*** and a general preference for Other Transactions Authority, application of Rapid Capabilities Office policies, or any other authorities or pathways to ***promote streamlined acquisitions*** under the Adaptive Acquisition Framework.”
- **Executive Order: Ensuring Commercial, Cost-effective Solutions In Federal Contracts, 16 April 2025**
 - “It is the policy of my Administration that agencies ***shall procure commercially available products and services***, including those that can be modified to fill agencies’ needs, to the maximum extent practicable.”

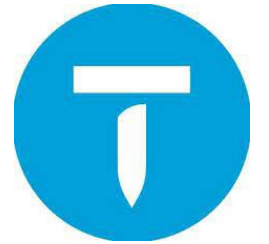
CSOs permanently authorized by section 803 of the FY22 NDAA (Pub. L. 117-81)

Overview

- **Why Now?**
- **How do CSOs Work?**
- **Sample Process Flow**
- **Backup (BAA Process)**

How do CSOs Work?

- **Definition (Austin):** An open-ended, general request for good ideas
- **Authority:** Section 803 of the FY22 NDAA provided the DoD with permanent CSO authority, codified in **10 U.S.C. §3458**
- **Implementation:** DFARS 212.70 (note commerciality)
- **Implications:**
 - Competitive, *Treated as Commercial*, Innovative:
 - Any technology, process, or method, including research and development, that is *new* as of the date of submission of a proposal,
or
 - Any *application* that is *new* as of the date of submission of a proposal of a technology, process, or method existing as of such date.



Similar to
“Thumbtack” App

A CSO is a solicitation method, not a contract

How do CSOs Work?

- **Meets CICA requirement for competition if CSO (DFARS 212.7004(a)(3)):**
 - Describes the evaluation factors for selecting proposals to include—
 - **Technical and importance to agency** programs as the primary evaluation factors;
 - **Price to the extent appropriate**, but at a minimum to determine that the price is fair and reasonable; and
 - **Relative importance of the factors**, and
 - **The method of evaluation**

Proposals not evaluated against each other since they are not submitted in response to a common PWS [DFARS 212.7004(c)]

How do CSOs Work? (cont.)

- **10 USC 3458(c)(3):**

- *Notwithstanding [the definition of commerciality in FAR 2] products and services acquired using the authority under subsection (a) **shall be treated as** commercial products and commercial services.*
[Implemented by DFARS 212.7002(c)]

- **Key implications of commercial contract:**

- No “Changes” clauses ✓
- No approved accounting system required ✓
- No Cost Accounting Standards (CAS) ✓
- No certified cost or pricing data ✓
- Fixed-price type contracts ✓
- Extremely limited set of clauses are included ✓

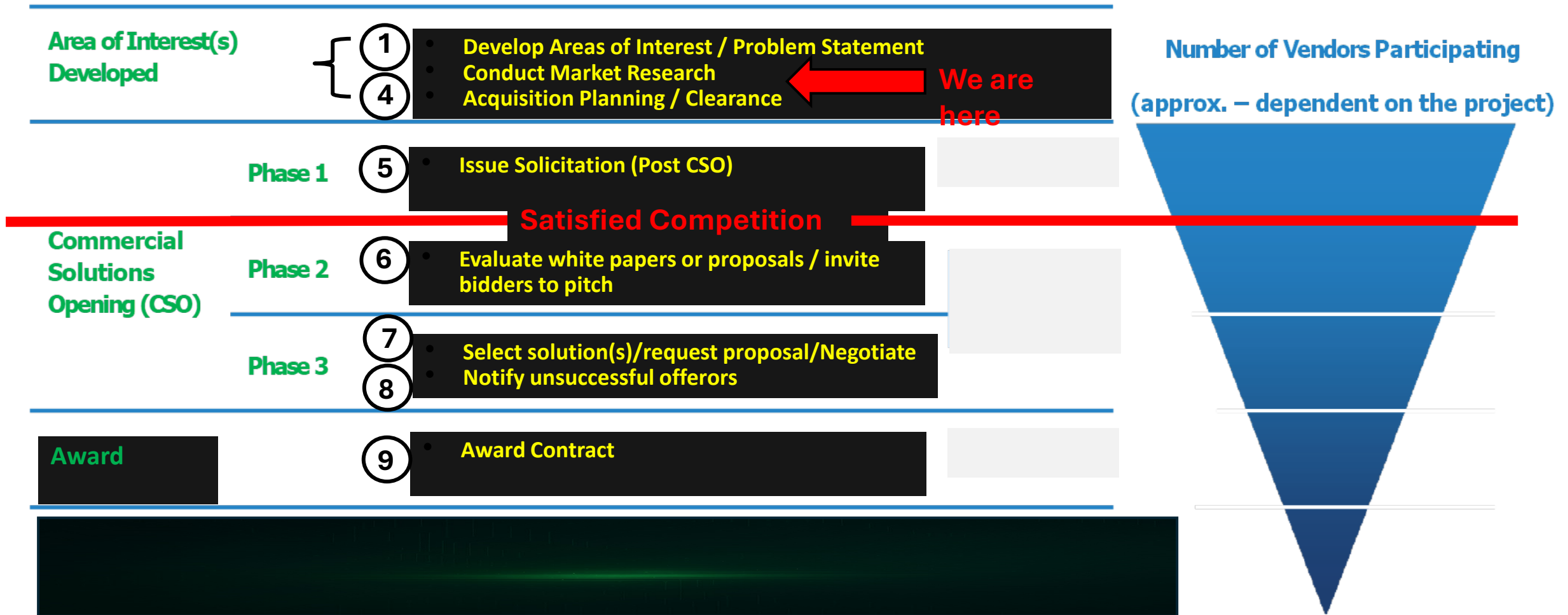
Streamlined measures meant to make contracting with the Government easier

How do CSOs Work? (cont.)

- **Similar method to Broad Agency Announcements (BAAs)**
 - BAAs were a successful and proven method, but only applied to R&D (more on BAAs in backup)
- **CSOs offer even greater flexibility than BAAs**
- **Contracts awarded from CSOs are always considered commercial**
 - Results in Fixed-Price type contracts
 - Meant to attract non-traditional defense contractors
 - May use all types of funds, including O&M

CSO blends *flexibility* of BAA with *streamlined* procedures of commercial

How do CSOs Work? (cont.)



Note: Steps 1-4 are iterative and can blend and/or overlap

How do CSOs Work? (cont.)

- **Step 1: Develop Areas of Interest (AOIs)**

- Meet with operators/users/functional experts/subject matter experts etc. to identify need, capability gap, or area for solution

- **Step 2: Conduct Market Research (MR)**

- MR may look different than for a traditional contract. Focus should be on what is missing rather than what is known



- **Step 3: Conduct Acquisition Planning**

- Determine if CSO should be One-Step/Two-Step, Open/Closed/Staggered Closed, Basic with Calls, should include Pitch Days, or will result in contract or Other Transaction (or the option for both/either)*

*More info available in backup slides

How do CSOs Work? (cont.)

- **Step 4: Obtain Clearance**

- Clearance requirements still apply to CSOs

- **Step 5: Issue Solicitation (Post CSO)**

- Competition requirements of FAR 6 have been met

SATISFIED Competition

- **Step 6: Evaluate White Papers and/or Proposals**

- Must be reviewed by Government technical experts
- Must be evaluated IAW terms of the CSO
- Primary evaluation factors shall always be:
 - Technical, Importance to agency programs, Funds availability

How do CSOs Work? (cont.)

- **Step 7: Select Solution(s)/Request Proposal/Negotiate**

- Categorize White Papers as “Recommended,” “Selectable,” or “Not Selectable”
- Government may award all, some, or none of a proposed solution (portions of an otherwise “Not Selectable” proposal may be awarded)
- Government may award as many “Recommended” or “Selectable” proposals as it has funding for
 - **ONE award is anticipated for CNECTS**
- The offeror with the “**Recommended**” White Paper that offers the most promising solution based on the eval criteria, **as determined by the subjective judgment of the SME review board**, will be issued an RFP
 - If a negotiated agreement can be reached at a fair and reasonable price, that offeror will win the award
 - Otherwise, the process moves to the next most promising solution

How do CSOs Work? (cont.)

- **Step 8: Notify Offerors**

- Notify offerors of results of White Paper evaluation results
 - Offerors with “**Not Selectable**” White Papers will be **eliminated from the competition**
 - Offerors with “**Selectable**” White Papers will be **held** and issued an RFP **only if no awards result** from “Recommended” White Papers

- **Step 9: Award Contract**

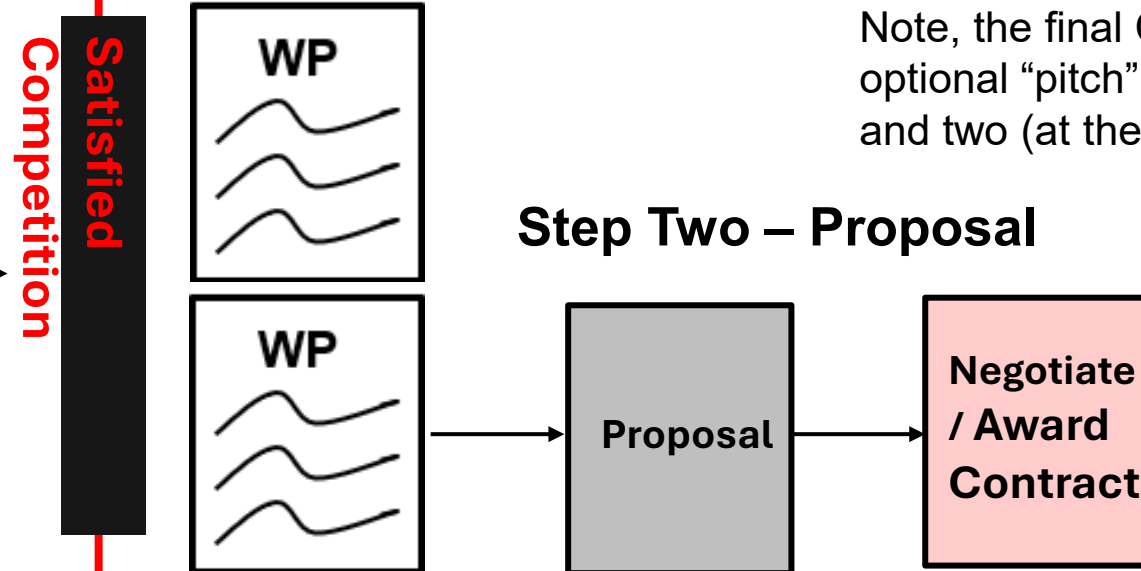
- If over \$100M, SAE approval and Congressional notification is required
 - Delegated to SCO (DAFFARS MP5301.601(a)(i), line 56)

How do CSOs Work? (cont.)

CNECTS is anticipated to be a *Two-Step, Closed CSO*, with *one* awardee:

Two-Step:

Step One – White Papers



AOI will consist of desired CNECTS services as illustrated in WBS and Bidders' Library info

The offeror with the **“Recommended”** White Paper that offers the most promising solution, **as determined by the subjective judgment of the SME review board**, will be issued a Request for Proposal (RFP)

How do CSOs Work? (cont.)

Recap:

- | | |
|---|---|
| • Competitive procedure under FAR 6.101 and DFARS 206.101-70(b) (RFO) | ✓ |
| • All products/services are <u>treated as</u> commercial notwithstanding the definition under FAR Subpart 2.101 | ✓ |
| • Authority from DFARS 212.70 used in conjunction with FAR part 12 procedures | ✓ |
| • Primary evaluation factors are technical, importance to agency needs and funds availability | ✓ |
| • Does not require the use of DoD Source Selection Procedures | ✓ |
| • Limited to Fixed Price contract types, including FPIF | ✓ |
| • Evaluated through SME review | ✓ |

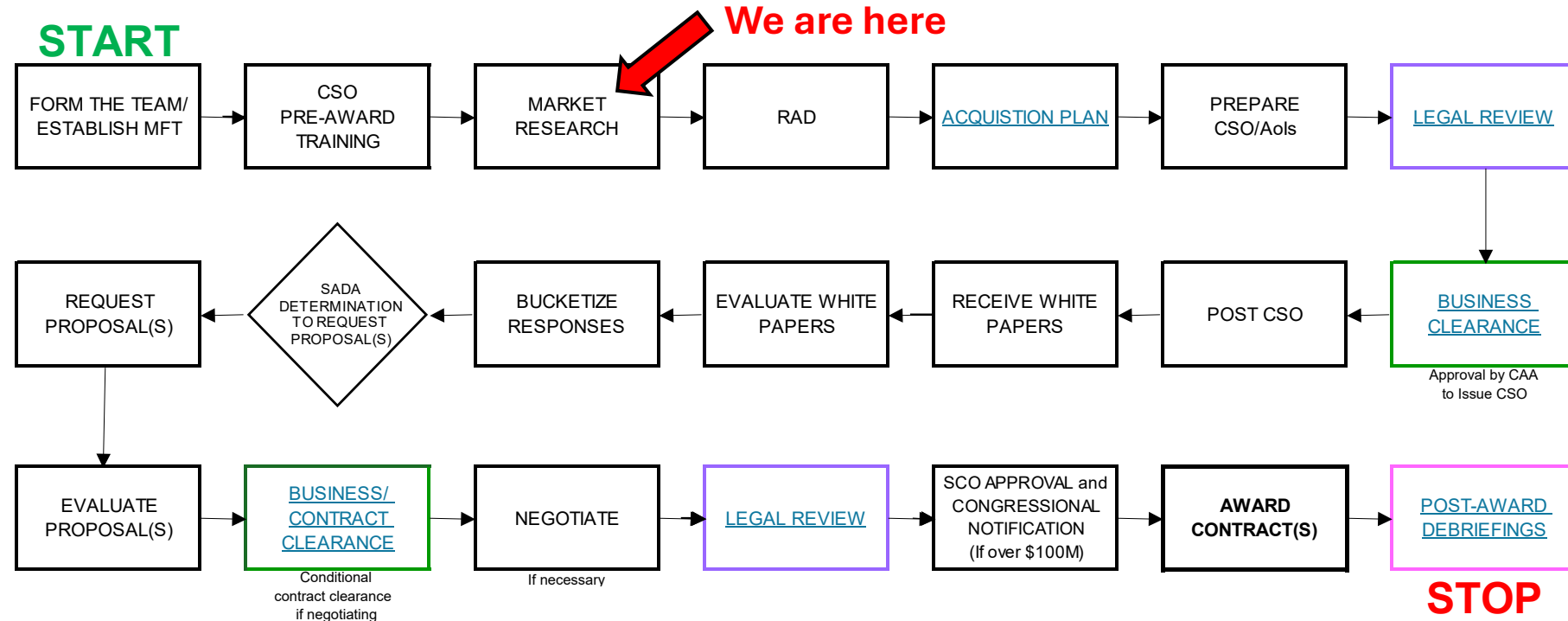
CNECTS is anticipated to be a *Two-Step, Closed* CSO, with *one* award to the offeror with most promising “Recommended” White Paper

Overview

- Why Now?
- How do CSOs Work?
- **Sample Process Flow**
- Backup (BAA Process)

Sample Process Flow

SAIO Commercial Solutions Openings Process Map



Legal Review	DAFFARS 5301.602-2
Clearance	DAFFARS 5301.90
Debriefs	FAR 15.505_506

DFARS 212.70 - Defense Commercial Solutions Openings

Abbreviations

Aol	Area of Interest
CAA	Clearance Approval Authority
CSO	Commercial Solutions Opening
SADA	Services Acquisition Decision Authority (DAFI 63-138 para 2.5)

CNECTS CSO Approach (contd)

- Contract Type Considerations
 - Fixed-price contract structure anticipated
 - Potential incentive fee on select CLINs under consideration
 - Contract type designed to balance risk between government and contractor
 - Seeking industry feedback on contract type approach and incentive structures

CNECTS CSO Approach (contd)

- Preliminary Submission Requirements
 - White paper submission anticipated as initial phase
 - Format, length, and content requirements under development
 - Potential for oral pitches and/or capability demonstrations
 - Seeking industry input on optimal submission approach

Areas for Industry Input

- White Paper Format and Content
 - What is the optimal page length for white papers to adequately convey your approach?
 - What content areas should be required vs optional?
 - Should white papers be structured by WBS element, functional area, location, or integrated narrative?
 - What attachments or supplementary materials should be permitted?
 - Are there formatting standards that facilitate or hinder your ability to respond effectively?

Areas for Industry Input (contd)

- Oral Presentations and Demonstrations
 - Would a "Pitch Day" format be effective for this requirement?
 - What is the optimal duration for oral pitches?
 - Should oral pitches focus on technical approach, key personnel, or both?
 - Would live or recorded capability demonstrations add value to the evaluation?
 - What demonstration scenarios would best showcase your capabilities?
 - Should demonstrations be conducted at contractor facilities, government facilities, or virtually?

Areas for Industry Input (contd)

- Contract Type and Structure
 - Is firm-fixed-price appropriate for all service areas, or should some CLINs be structured differently?
 - Which CLINs or service areas would benefit from incentive fee structures?
 - What performance metrics should drive incentive fee determinations?
 - How should the contract accommodate technology refresh and modernization over the period of performance?
 - What flexibility mechanisms would support evolving mission requirements?

Areas for Industry Input (contd)

- Industry Risk Consideration
 - What risks do you foresee from the contractor perspective?
 - What risks should the government be aware of in structuring this acquisition?
 - How can the CSO process be structured to mitigate identified risks?
 - Are there transition risks that should be specifically addressed?
 - What market conditions may impact pricing or performance?

Areas for Industry Input (contd)

- Period of Performance
 - What transition period and option period structure is optimal for this requirement?
 - How does period of performance impact your ability to invest in innovation and modernization?
 - Are there considerations for phase-in/phase-out periods?

Areas for Industry Input (contd)

- Teaming and Subcontracting
 - How does the closed CSO approach impact teaming arrangements?
 - What timeline is needed to finalize teaming agreements prior to submission?
 - Are there small business teaming considerations we should address?

Discussion Questions

- Open Forum
 - What aspects of the CSO process require additional clarification?
 - Are there barriers to participation that we should address?
 - What additional information would help you prepare the most competitive response?
 - How can we structure the evaluation to best assess your capabilities?
 - What lessons learned from other CSO procurements should we consider?

Break for Lunch

Please return by 1345

Base Infrastructure Modernization

Please provide comments and discussion on
BIM experiences and information during this time.

BIM

BASE INFRASTRUCTURE
MODERNIZATION

Base Infrastructure Modernization

TASK ORDER 3 Town Hall
13/15 January 2026



Base Infrastructure Modernization

Who we are

Government Points of Contact



BIM Program Management Office -- AFLCMC/HNIB -- PEO Cyber & Networks (C&N)

Base Area Network (BAN) Program Manager: Wayne Anderson

Task Order 3 Program Manager: Capt Joshua Souza

Deputy Program Manager: Celine Lizotte

Contract Officer: Capt Nancy Bahnasy

Contract Specialist: Terri Rutkiewicz

Primary COR: Capt Joshua Souza

Deputy COR: Katie Poole

BIM Task Order 3 Contractor: CACI, Inc.

Contractor Program Manager: John Wall



Bottom Line Up Front

BIM is an enterprise-wide effort in the Connect Portfolio seeking to bring existing Air Force Information Network (AFIN) Infrastructure (Classified and Unclassified) into the 21st Century by providing critical IT updates. Transitioning from current Government Owned Government Operated (GOGO) NIPR and SIPR networks to Government Owned Contractor Operated (GOCO).



SCOPE & SERVICES



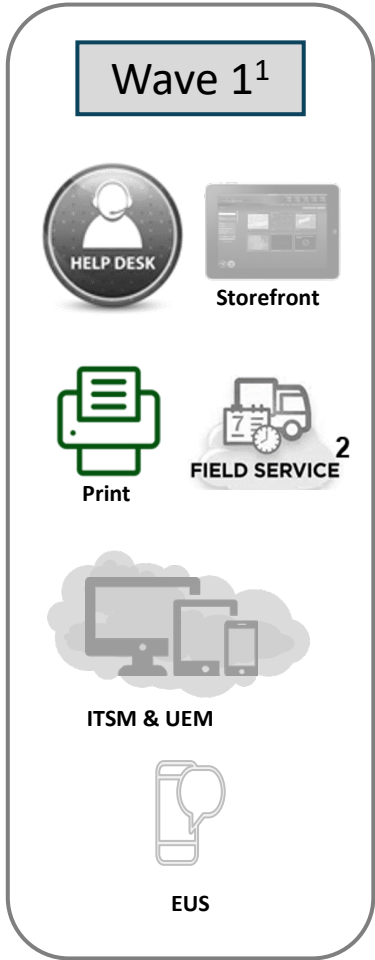
BIM Services – Vendor AOR



End User Devices²

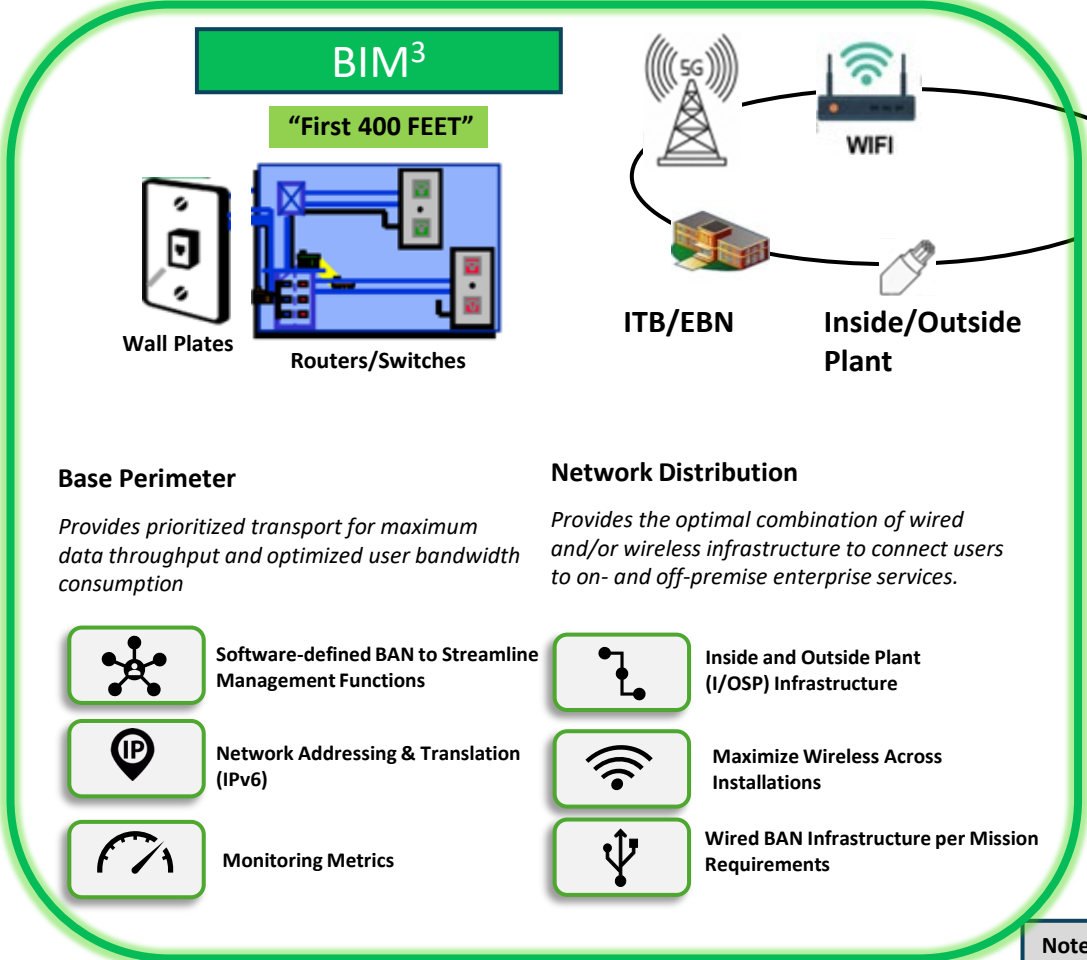


BAN – Base Area Network Node	ITSM – IT Service Management
BIM – Base Infrastructure Modernization	ITB – Information Transfer Building
BoD – Bandwidth on Demand	NIPRNet/SIPRNet – Non-Secure Internet Protocol Router Network/Secure Internet Protocol Router
BYOAD – Bring Your Own Approved Device	RRE – Risk Reduction Effort
CEDC – Component Enterprise Data Center	SDP – Service Delivery Point
COPE – Corporately Owned, Personally Enabled	TDC – Theater Deployable Comm
DoDIN – DOD Intranet	UEM – Unified Endpoint Management
EBN – Edge Building Node	VOIP/VoSIP – Voice Over Internet Protocol/ Voice
EUS – End User Service	WiFi – Wireless Fidelity of things
GFE – Government Furnished Equipment	ZT – Zero Trust
GSU – Geographically Separated Unit	ISN – Installation Services
IoT/IIoT – Internet of Things/ Industrial Internet of things	
ISN – Installation Services	

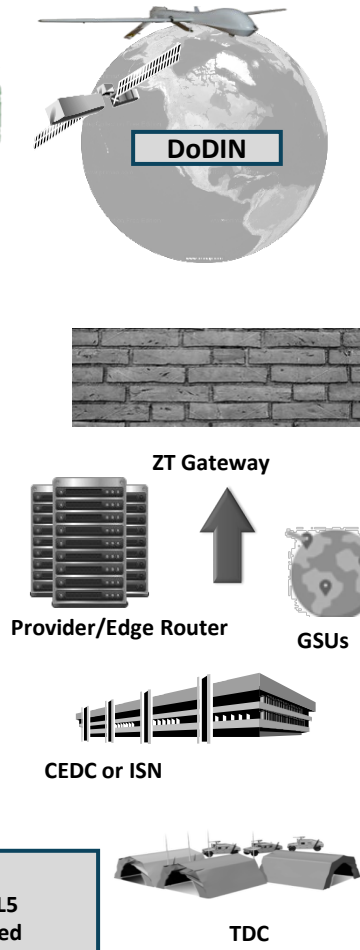


ITSM Platform: discovery, cyber security, IT planning, system integration, testing/evaluation, analysis/guidance, software mgmt, systems administration, hardware/software procurement, software configuration, architecture infrastructure mgmt., system mgmt, configuration mgmt database, data analytics

Base Area Network



LONG HAUL



- Notes:**
1. NIPRNet IL5
 2. Unit Funded
 3. NIPRNet/SIPRNet

Crosswalk: Comm Sq & BIM Services



CURRENT COMM SQUADRON FUNCTIONS

SPECIAL MISSION FLIGHT

- SATCOM (Systems, Nodes, Antennas and Radios)
- Coalition, Mission Networks and PMO Systems
- Special Mission
- Expeditionary Comms
- Mission Defense Teams

PLANNING & SUPPORT FLIGHT

- Publications
- Quality Assurance
- Resource Advisor
- Knowledge Management
- FOIA/PII/Records Management
- Frequency Management
- Comms planning
- COMSEC
- Software License Management
- Wing Cyber Security Office/Information Assurance

SQUADRON LEADERSHIP

- Commander, Deputy, & Flight Leadership
- Command Support Staff
- Administrative Support Staff(s)

SQUADRON BASE OPERATIONS FLIGHT

- LMRs
- Marquee Management
- Tech Control

1 Network Management / Infrastructure

2 Network Operations

3 Inside Plant / Outside Plant Cable Infrastructure

4 Voice Operations and Infrastructure

5 Continuity Of Operations (COOP)

- PA System
- JWICS Support
- Giant Voice
- Ground Radio
- CAT/EOC Support
- Service Desk – Remote (NIPR/SIPR) / Comms Focal Point (CFP)
- IT Asset Management
- Device Management / CST
- Vulnerability Management
- Exec/VIP Support
- Mobile Devices / PWCS
- Telephone Devices and User Support (User Focused)
- Telephone Operators
- VTC Operations (NIPR/SIPR)

EXPECTED IMPACT TO COMM SQUADRON FUNCTIONS

- IMPACT 1
- BIM Vendor** will provide systems configuration, switching, routing, and data transport services and equipment for black core, unclassified, and secret-level networks.
 - Comm Squadron** will provide network operations for mission systems as required.

- IMPACT 2
- BIM Vendor** will monitor, manage, and respond to alerts on their network's availability and performance for black core, unclassified, and secret-level networks.
 - Comm Squadron** will monitor, manage, and respond to alerts on functional and mission systems as required.

- IMPACT 3
- BIM Vendor** will be only implementing ISP/OSP for the relevant implementations under BIM.
 - Comm Squadron** will no longer be required to provide this service for AFNET.

- IMPACT 4
- BIM Vendor** will integrate BAN solution with existing telephony and maintain copper and upgrade to fiber as required.
 - Comm Squadron** will continue to provide telephony services by maintaining and upgrading equipment as required.

- IMPACT 5
- BIM Vendor** will comply with base COOP and disaster recovery plan; even during wartime.
 - Comm Squadron** will build and maintain the COOP plan, directing the on and off boarding of capabilities as required.

BIM VENDOR SERVICES

Network Distribution

Network Availability & ITSM

Network Distribution

Network Distribution

Network Distribution

Network Operations

All services are for **NIPR** & **SIPR** domains, though implementation may not be simultaneous (IAW EITaa PCD)

The BIM Concept of Operations outlines the responsibilities of key parties, to include Comm Squadrons and the enterprise vendor.



Comm Squadron Will Execute...

- On-Premise Services, Clouds & Applications
- POTS, VoIP, and Cloud-hosted Telephony Systems
- Tactical Systems and Simulators for Training or Mission Planning Purposes
- Mission Systems/Networks and ATO Process
- BAN Risk Management Framework*
- GSUs out of scope for BIM*



BIM Vendor Will Execute...

- BIM Vendor will execute to SLAs for the following scope:*
- Fiber Infrastructure (ISP/OSP)
 - Holistic Wired & Wireless Across Installations
 - Bandwidth Scalability
 - On-Site Service Restoration
 - Network Health and Performance Monitoring
 - Risk Management Framework Artifacts



16th Air Force Will Execute...

- Operations of Base Boundary
- Cyber Security CONEMP updates
- Support Delivery of EIT Services
- Enforce Network Security Requirements
- Enterprise-Wide Cyber Risk Management
- Data Analysis of Captured Network Data
- Provide SMEs to Support Strategy, Design and Transition

**Requires BIM vendor support/participation, but Comm Sqdn is OPR*

**GSUs 1067 process through MAJCOM*

*All services are for **NIPR** & **SIPR** domains, though implementation may not be simultaneous (IAW EITaaS PCD)*

BIM at 21 CS



- 21st Communications Squadron Civilian Personnel will provide all support to the base and its customers through the administration of both the legacy BITI network and the modernized network.
 - As the BIM TO3 vendor CACI will maintain the ability to provide this support if required.
- The BIM TO3 vendor CACI will provide a modernized solution to replace the current network at Peterson SFB, Schriever SFB, and Cheyenne Mountain SFS to include hardware, maintenance systems, and ISP/OSP cable infrastructure.
- The BIM TO3 vendor CACI will provide support to the 21st Communications Squadron through the development patches and changes to be deployed on modernized hardware.
 - The 21st Communications Squadron will utilize these patches and changes to keep hardware and systems operational and within compliance.

- The BIM TO3 vendor CACI is a partner in the greater 21st Communication Squadron team. The BIM TO3 PMO expects CACI to be responsive and provide support as needed to all stakeholders aboard Peterson SFB, Schriever SFB, and Cheyenne Mountain SFS to include all current and future contractors.
 - BIM TO3 has 2 government site leads provided by the 21st Communication Squadron as well as technical points of contact from each site. This team can provide insight into the work being done at the site and will aid in communication with the BIM TO3 PMO and CACI.
 - CACI has a local site lead who can provide any support and guidance on the BIM TO3 scope of work and current tasks at any time.

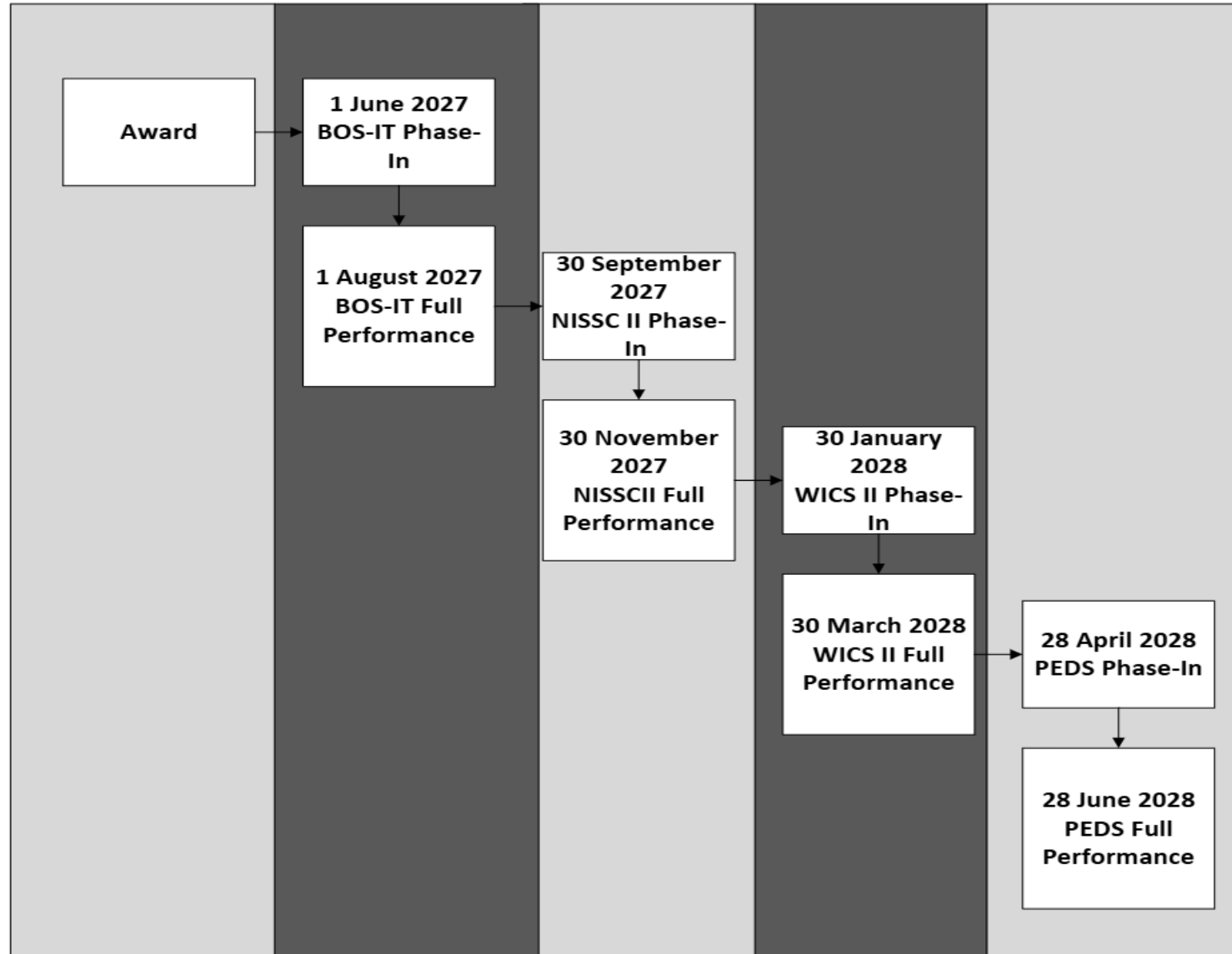
CNECTS Milestones

- Industry Day – March 11th
 - Industry Day 1:1s – March 12th – 1 April
 - Contact Michael Tidwell or Rosalind Davis to schedule
 - Limited to 30 Minutes
- Draft CSO Release – 23 March
- Acquisition Plan Finalized – 1 May
- CSO Release – 1 June
- Initial Submission Due – 15 July
- Selection Complete and Proposal Request – 1 August
- Target Negotiations Complete – 31 October
- SADA Signed ADM – 20 November
- Award – 1 December
- Phase In Begins (Assuming 60-day Transition) – 1 June 2027
- Full Performance Begins – 1 August 2027

CNECTS Engagement Opportunities

- SAIO will continue 1:1 engagements until 1 April
- Draft CSO release
 - Provide feedback on submission, evaluation, and proposal structure and format
 - Provide feedback on final CLIN structure
 - Provide feedback on opportunities for government clarification
- Potential future RFIs to streamline acquisition strategy
- Questions may be sent directly to the acquisition team
 - Answers to consolidated Q&As will be posted to SAM.gov

Projected Rollout



Questions, Comments, Concerns, Discussion?



The seal of the Space Acquisition and Integration Office is a circular emblem. It features a stylized rocket or space station structure in the center, with a star above it. The words "SPACE ACQUISITION" are written in a curve along the top, and "INTEGRATION OFFICE" is written along the bottom. The main text of the slide is overlaid on this seal.

Thank you for attending CNECTS Industry Day

Hosted by the Space Acquisition and Integration Office

Michael S. Tidwell – Program Manager

Rosalind Y. Davis – Contracting Officer

Austin Frindt – Acquisition Instructor



Broad Agency Announcement (BAA)

Easier to understand CSOs if we first understand BAAs

Explanation

- **Broad Agency Announcement (BAA) (FAR 35.016):** Competitive selection of basic and applied research and that part of development not related to the development of a specific system or hardware procurement
 - A BAA is general in nature identifying areas of research interest, including criteria for selecting proposals, and soliciting the participation of all offerors capable of satisfying the Government's needs
 - Requires a peer or scientific review as a method of evaluation
 - The BAA technique shall only be used when meaningful proposals with varying technical/scientific approaches can be reasonably anticipated.

Explanation (cont.)

- **BAAs may be Open, Closed, or a combination thereof:**
 - **Open**
 - The BAA is “open” for an extended period, generally one to five years (must be updated annually)
 - White papers and/or proposals may be submitted at any time within the open period
 - **Closed**
 - The BAA has a fixed closing date and white papers and/or proposals will only be accepted if received before the closing date (late proposal rules generally apply)
 - **“Staggered-Closed”**
 - The BAA has a fixed closing date, but also allows for proposals/white papers after the closing date; however, the funding of proposals received after the closing date is significantly reduced (late proposal

Explanation (cont.)

- **BAAs may be general in nature and have “Calls”:**
 - A basic BAA is published, containing overarching information, serving as a framework for identifying the technical areas and giving the basic terms and administrative information
 - Requests for white papers and/or proposals are transmitted via Calls that are published separately from the basic BAA at various times during the open period of the basic BAA
 - The basic BAA is usually “open,” and the Calls are usually “Closed” or “Staggered-Closed”
 - Similar in concept to IDIQ contracts and BPAs

Explanation (cont.)

- **BAAs may be One-Step or Two-Step:**
 - **One-step** – BAA explains how proposals will be evaluated
 - 1) Proposals (full technical and cost) are submitted by each offeror.
 - The proposals are reviewed in accordance with the solicitation criteria and **all, some, or none** of an offeror's proposal may be selected for award
 - **Two-Step** – BAA explains how white papers will be reviewed and evaluated and how proposals will be evaluated, if requested
 - 1) White Papers containing a proposed technical approach and rough order of magnitude (ROM) are submitted by each offeror
 - 2) Proposals (full technical and cost) may be submitted by offerors with favorably evaluated white papers
 - Proposals are reviewed in same manner as One-step

Evaluation

- **White Papers and/or Proposals are “Peer Reviewed”**
 - **White Papers**
 - Scientific Technical experts will review the white paper to determine its overall technical value and interest to the Government
 - Offerors that submitted white papers found to be of interest may be requested to submit formal technical and cost proposals by a specific date
 - **Proposals**
 - Scientific Technical experts will review the proposal in accordance with criteria specified in the BAA or Call
 - Proposals are reviewed solely on the criteria published in the BAA. The proposal must stand on its own merits as submitted

Award

- **Proposals will be categorized as either Selectable or Not Selectable**
 - **Selectable**
 - Proposals are recommended for acceptance if sufficient funding is available
 - **Not Selectable**
 - Even if sufficient funding existed, the proposal should not be funded
- Remember: the Government reserves the right to award **some, all, or none of a proposal**
 - When only some of the proposal is desired, the selected part may be categorized as Selectable, though the overall proposal may be categorized as Not Selectable
- **The Government may make as many awards as it has funding for**

Contracts and Assistance Instruments

- **Awards from a BAA may result in a non-FAR-based “assistant instrument” rather than a contract**
 - Grant
 - Cooperative Agreement (CA)
 - Other Transaction (OT) for Research
 - Technology Investment Agreement (TIA)
- Assistance Instruments are appropriate when the goal is to accomplish a public purpose
- A FAR-based contract is appropriate when the goal is to purchase goods or services for the direct benefit of the government
- Thus, BAAs are typically posted at both Grants.gov and SAM.gov (GPE)

Differences Between CSOs and BAAs (cont.)

Similarities

	CSO	BAA
• Competitive procedure under FAR 6.101 (RFO)	✓	✓
• Meaningful proposals with varying technical/scientific approaches can be reasonably anticipated	✓	✓
• Many variations: closed, open, closed/open with one or two step procedures	✓	✓
• Can result in the award of a contract or OT as long as specified in solicitation	✓	✓
• Does not require the use of DoD Source Selection Procedures	✓	✓
• Evaluated through Peer or Scientific Review	✓	✓
• Primary evaluation factors are technical, importance to agency needs and funds availability	✓	✓

Differences Between CSOs and BAAs

Differences

	CSO	BAA
• All products/services are <i>treated as</i> commercial notwithstanding the definition under FAR Subpart 2.101	✓	✗
• All funding types, including O&M, may be used	✓	✗
• Limited to Fixed Price contract types, including FPIF	✓	✗
• Use Part 12 procedures in conjunction with FAR Part 35 when procuring R&D	✓	✗
• No Commercial Item Determination is required	✓	✗
• May award a grant or cooperative agreement	✗ (OTs okay)	✓
• May exceed \$100M without SPE Approval	✗	✓